



Celebrations and eliminations

The "Mouvement National" takes to the streets of Phnom Penh to welcome the Khmer Rouge in 1975. Despite its popular support, the group was thought to be run by members of Lon Nol's regime and was soon eliminated.

Tyranny begins

The Khmer Rouge leadership was already determined to eliminate all threats to their new order. Within hours of entering the city, they ordered more than two million people to leave Phnom Penh for the countryside. Those who resisted or were unable to travel were murdered. The "new people," urbanized and of mixed ethnicities, unlike the pure Khmer peasants, were the main target of the mysterious Saloth Sar (now known as Pol Pot). The people were told that they must evacuate for safety from American bombing, assured that they would return within a few days when the city was secure. Restoring their old homes and old lives, however, was not Pol Pot's true plan.